Approaches to Staffing

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An introduction to staffing

- Effective **human resource management (staffing)** is important to business as it ensures that the organisation has:
  - The right people, in the right roles, with the right support, with opportunities to succeed
- This leads to **higher productivity**, more profits and a **positive work environment**
- Human resource management focuses on how employees can be effectively
  - Recruited
  - Deployed (used)
  - Developed and trained
  - Motivated
  - Managed and led

Staff as an asset and as a cost

- Staff represent both an **asset** and a **cost** to a business
- Staff are an **asset** to a business, as they bring knowledge, skills and expertise to the business
  - Staff can increase productivity, drive innovation and enhance customer service — all of which contribute to the success and profitability of the business
  - Staff can help to **build a positive reputation** for the business through their interactions with customers, suppliers and other stakeholders
- Staff also generate **costs** to a business — and, for many businesses, staffing is **one of the largest costs** they have
  - There are costs associated with:
    - Hiring and training workers
    - Managing workers, as managers have to be hired
    - Paying **salaries** of full-time workers
    - Paying **wages** of hourly staff
    - Additional benefits, such as company cars, pensions, healthcare, etc.
    - Letting workers go (**redundancy payments**)

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

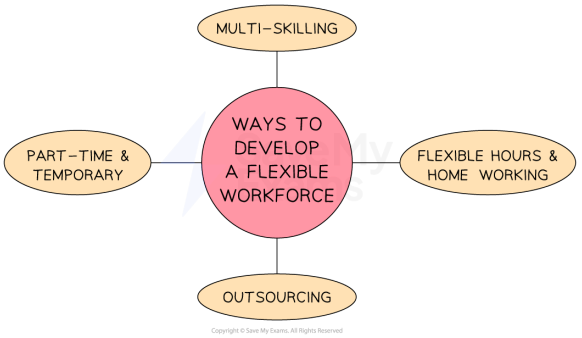
- The introduction or increase of a **national minimum wage** is relevant to employees who receive a wage rather than a salary
  - Businesses that employ workers on a wage basis may face **higher labour costs**
  - Businesses that employ workers on a salary basis are less affected by the introduction of a minimum wage
    - They already **pay a fixed amount** regardless of the number of hours worked

Developing a flexible workforce

- **Flexible working** is the development of a culture where workers are equipped to **do different roles** or where they work in a range of employment patterns (full-time, part-time, **zero hours contracts**, work from home, etc.)

- Developing a flexible workforce can **bring many benefits** to a business
  - Each specific approach should be assessed, as there are potential disadvantages to each

Ways to develop a flexible workforce



Allowing workers to work from home is just one of several methods available to businesses to develop a flexible workforce

Multi-skilling

- Multi-skilling is the process of training workers to **fulfil multiple job roles** within a business
  - E.g. Southwest Airlines trains staff to handle multiple roles, including check-in, baggage handling and customer service

Advantages and disadvantages of multi-skilling

Advantages	Disadvantages

Help me understand

labour costs and increases **productivity** • It can help to improve patient outcomes in **healthcare industries**, as workers with a broader range of skills can provide more comprehensive care	training and development • May not be appropriate for all job roles, especially those that require a **high level of expertise**

Part-time and temporary working

- Someone who works **part-time** may only work two or three days a week
- Someone who works temporarily shows up for work whenever the business needs them
  - E.g. Amazon employs temporary workers to handle seasonal spikes in demand, such as Christmas

Advantages and disadvantages of part-time and temporary working

Advantages	Disadvantages
• **Flexible working arrangements** can help businesses to attract and retain talent, especially staff who value work-life balance • This may improve productivity, as staff can work **during their most productive hours** and avoid distractions	• **Flexible working arrangements** can create challenges in terms of communication and collaboration (especially if staff are working remotely) • **Monitoring and managing flexible workers** can be more difficult

Outsourcing

- Apple **outsources** much of its manufacturing to Foxconn in China
  - This allows Apple to **produce products at a lower cost** and maintain competitive pricing

Advantages and disadvantages of outsourcing

Advantages	Disadvantages
• This may allow businesses to **access specialised skills** that may not be available in-house	• This may lead to a loss of control over quality and delivery, especially if the outsourcing partner is based in another country

	country with **lower labour standards** or human rights abuses

Flexible hours

- Flexible hours allow employees to **schedule working hours around their individual needs** and accommodate their commitments outside of work
- A flexible-hours schedule usually involves **working some set hours**, with the remainder of hours organised according to the employees' needs
  - E.g. An employee may be expected to be at work between the hours of 10 am and 2 pm, but they can choose when they complete the rest of their working hours

Home working

- **Advances in communication technology** have enabled a larger proportion of workers than ever before to work from home
  - Employees use tools such as **email**, **instant messaging**, **collaborative software**, **scheduling apps** and **videoconferencing** to carry out work remotely
- Home working has a range of advantages and disadvantages for both the business and its employees

Advantages and disadvantages of homeworking

	Advantages	Disadvantages
For the Business	• Smaller or fewer premises may be required, **reducing costs** • High-quality workers may be attracted from a wide geographical area • Workers may be **more productive** if they work in isolation, away from distractions	• The cost of equipping workers with technology to work remotely may be significant • There may be **less opportunity for collaboration** between workers, reducing innovation • Careful monitoring is required to ensure remote workers remain focused on tasks
For the Employee	• Commuting costs, such as train fares, are eliminated	• Staff may **feel isolated** from colleagues

	work • Some flexibility may be possible, allowing workers to manage other commitments	increase • A healthy division between work and home life may be difficult to manage

The distinction between dismissal and redundancy

Dismissal

- **Dismissal** (firing or sacking) is the **termination of employment by an employer** against the will of the employee
  - Employees are usually terminated due to their **misconduct** (e.g. violating company policy) or **poor performance**
  - The employer may choose to dismiss them immediately (without notice or compensation) or provide a notice period, which the employee can work out

Redundancy

- Employees are **made redundant** when their job is no longer available and the business **reduces the size of its workforce**
  - The termination is not due to any fault of the employee
  - The employer must **follow certain legal procedures**, including providing notice and paying redundancy compensation

Different approaches to employer/employee relationships

- The nature of the employer/employee relationship is influenced by whether there is an **individual approach** or a **collective agreement**

Individual and collective bargaining approaches

Individual Approach	Collective Bargaining
• Focuses on the relationship between an	• A process whereby a group of employees (represented by a **trade**

employee is unique and has their own goals, motivations and interests
• It emphasises the need for **tailored compensation packages** that cater to each employee's unique skills and needs
• The **employment relationship** is a voluntary agreement between two parties in which both negotiate their respective roles, responsibilities and benefits
• The employer has the power to hire, fire and set the **terms and conditions** of employment
	conditions and benefits
	• Employees have **more bargaining power** when they **negotiate collectively** rather than as individuals
	• The employment relationship is seen as a **power struggle** between two parties with conflicting interests
	  ○ The employer wants to **maximise profits** by keeping labour costs low
	  ○ The employees want to **maximise their wages** and benefits
	  ○ The union acts as the **collective voice** of the employees and bargains with the employer on behalf of all workers

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